

Daily Bible Note

Date: July 23, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 29:1-16

1 In the tenth year, in the tenth month, on the twelfth day of the month, the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 "Son of man, set your face against Pharaoh king of Egypt, and prophesy against him, and against all Egypt.

3 Speak, and say, 'Thus says the Lord God: "Behold, I am against you, O Pharaoh king of Egypt, O great monster who lies in the midst of his rivers, Who has said, 'My River is my own; I have made it for myself.'

4 But I will put hooks in your jaws, And cause the fish of your rivers to stick to your scales; I will bring you up out of the midst of your rivers, And all the fish in your rivers will stick to your scales.

5 I will leave you in the wilderness, You and all the fish of your rivers; You shall fall on the open field; You shall not be picked up or gathered. I have given you as food To the beasts of the field And to the birds of the heavens.

6 Then all the inhabitants of Egypt Shall know that I am the Lord, Because they have been a staff of reed to the house of Israel.

7 When they took hold of you with the hand, You broke and tore all their shoulders; When they leaned on you, You broke and made all their backs quiver."

8 'Therefore thus says the Lord God: "Surely I will bring a sword upon you and cut off from you man and beast.

9 And the land of Egypt shall become desolate and waste; then they will know that I am the Lord, because he said, 'The River is mine, and I have made it.'

10 Indeed, therefore, I am against you and against your rivers, and I will make the land of Egypt utterly waste and desolate, from Migdol to Syene, as far as the border of Ethiopia.

11 Neither foot of man shall pass through it nor foot of beast pass through it, and it shall be

uninhabited forty years.

12 I will make the land of Egypt desolate in the midst of the countries that are desolate; and among the cities that are laid waste, her cities shall be desolate forty years; and I will scatter the Egyptians among the nations and disperse them throughout the countries."

13 'Yet, thus says the Lord God: "At the end of forty years I will gather the Egyptians from the peoples among whom they were scattered.

14 I will bring back the captives of Egypt and cause them to return to the land of Pathros, to the land of their origin, and there they shall be a lowly kingdom.

15 It shall be the lowliest of kingdoms; it shall never again exalt itself above the nations, for I will diminish them so that they will not rule over the nations anymore.

16 No longer shall it be the confidence of the house of Israel, but will remind them of their iniquity when they turned to follow them. Then they shall know that I am the Lord God.'""

II. Key Summary

- This prophecy is dated "in the tenth year, in the tenth month, on the twelfth day"; the Lord tells Ezekiel to set his face against Pharaoh king of Egypt and prophesy against him and all Egypt.
 - Pharaoh boasts, "My River is my own; I have made it for myself," so God says He will put hooks in this great monster lying in the river, drag it out, and leave it in the wilderness.
 - God says Egypt has been "a staff of reed" to Israel that breaks when leaned on; He will make Egypt desolate for forty years, then gather the Egyptians back, but they will be the lowliest of kingdoms.
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III. Passage Analysis

Treating yourself as the source of everything is really forgetting God

It is a graphic method of again drawing attention to the fact that all forgetfulness of God amounts at last to self-deification. That is the sin of every king and of every people who fail to recognise God. [1]

Pharaoh's line, "My River is my own; I have made it for myself," takes credit for the Nile—the

source of all Egypt's wealth and life. When we assume everything we hold is something we earned on our own, we've quietly pushed God out of the picture.

A staff of reed: leaning on the wrong thing only hurts you

A confidence which has failed those that depended upon it, or has done them more hurt than good; for if a reed is leaned upon as a staff, it most certainly bends under the weight and breaks. [2]

Israel wanted Egypt's army to save them from Babylon, but Egypt was like a reed staff—it looks strong enough to lean on, yet it snaps under pressure and cuts the hand that grips it. God removes the unreliable support so His people will put their trust back in Him.

IV. Reflection Question

When you're under pressure or things fall apart, what's the first thing you reach for—a certain friend, your grades, your phone, or something else that makes you feel safe?

Ezekiel says Egypt was like a staff of reed—it looked strong enough to lean on, but it snapped under the weight; God reminded His people that He is the one who actually holds them up.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik Commentary (quoting G. Campbell Morgan), <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-29/>

[2] BibleHub, Matthew Henry's Commentary on Ezekiel 29:6-7, <https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/ezekiel/29-6.htm>